

Plate 3.63 Ash Tray

Central appointments add an extra tone and attention to the table. They are usually placed at the centre of the table.

1. **Flower arrangement:** A small flower vase is an apt centerpiece. The flowers used should be fresh and healthy and not too fragrant. Large flower arrangement should not be kept on the table, because it can block visions of the guests sitting opposite to each other.



Plate 3.64 Flower Arrangement

2. **Cruet set:** The cruet set should be filled with salt and pepper which can be made up of metal, ceramic, glass or stainless steel. The contents should be free flowing with appropriate number of holes depend on the style of service (commonly three holes for pepper and two holes for salt). Adding a few uncooked rice grains to the salt shaker soaks up the excess moisture and keeps the salt from clumping. In Southern India, along with cruet set may contain pickles, different types of podis (like paruppu podi, idli podi) and chutneys.



Plate 3.65 Cruet Set

3.2 Table Setting / Laying the Cover

Courteous and personalized service is an essential quality of service staff in all restaurants. Setting up cover for servicing by following standardized norms, will not only help staff to concentrate on guests satisfaction but also give a feel of royal treatment to the guests. Using covers as a basis for predicting sales revenue enables a restaurant to decide the number of servers or waiters needed. Careful serving timing also can increase the value of covers.

It is essential for service staff to master the art of setting up cover, as per the need of the service (example A'la carte or Table d'hôte). One of the important activities of service staff is setting of cover prior to the arrival of the guests and after taking the food order. The cover with inappropriate cutlery or using a wrong cutlery may lead to bad experience for the guest and affect the business.